

CHRIST HIDDEN IN PLAIN SIGHT

How the Whole Old Testament Was Pointing to Jesus All Along

“Beginning from Moses and from all the prophets, he explained to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself.”

Luke 24:27 (WEB)

HOPE OF GLORY MINISTRY

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A Note on the Scriptures

Every verse in this book is quoted from the **World English Bible (WEB)**, a public-domain translation that anyone may read, copy, and share freely — a free Bible for a free gospel. The WEB also renders the divine name as "**Yahweh**," which helps when we are tracing the God of the Old Testament into the New.

This is a book about reading the Bible the way Jesus read it. You do not need to be a scholar. You need only be willing to follow the thread.

A Note to Every Reader

There are two ways to read the Old Testament. The first is to read it as a closed museum — a collection of ancient laws, wars, and poems with no particular destination. The second is to read it the way Jesus and His apostles read it: as a single unfolding story that was, from the first page, leaning forward toward a person.

This book makes the second case. It argues that the Old Testament is not a different religion that got replaced, nor a long preface that can be skipped, but a portrait being painted slowly, in layers, over centuries — and that when the subject of the portrait finally walked into the room, those with eyes to see recognized Him.

To the Christian: this will deepen your confidence that the Bible is one book with one Author and one center.

To the doubter: read the texts and judge for yourself whether the pattern is real or imagined. We will show our work.

To the Jewish reader: these are your Scriptures, read with the deepest respect. We believe they point to the Messiah; you may disagree. We will never caricature your tradition, and we will quote the texts honestly. Read, and weigh.

We compare readings; we never demean people. Here is the claim of the whole book, in one line: *the Old Testament is Christ hidden in plain sight*.

Chapter One — The Reading Lesson on the Road

Two travelers and a stranger

On the first Easter afternoon, two disciples walk the seven miles from Jerusalem to a village called Emmaus, talking about the catastrophe of the weekend — the execution of the teacher they had hoped was the Messiah. A stranger joins them. They do not recognize Him. And then He does something extraordinary: He gives them a Bible study.

"Beginning from Moses and from all the prophets, he explained to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself." — Luke 24:27 (WEB)

The stranger is the risen Jesus. And His claim is staggering: that "all the Scriptures" — the Law of Moses, the Prophets, the Psalms — are, in some real sense, "concerning himself." Later that evening, when their eyes are opened and He vanishes, they say to each other: "Weren't our hearts burning within us, while he spoke to us by the way, and while he opened the Scriptures to us?" (Luke 24:32).

That is the reading lesson this whole book is built on. Jesus did not treat the Old Testament as an outdated rulebook. He treated it as a portrait of Himself that His own people had been looking at without seeing.

The method, in His own words

Jesus said it directly to His critics: "You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me" (John 5:39). And again: "If you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me" (John 5:46).

So we are not inventing a Christian gimmick of finding Jesus under every rock. We are following the explicit method of Jesus and His apostles, who read the Hebrew Scriptures as a forward-leaning testimony. The apostle Paul summarized the whole gospel as something that happened "according to the Scriptures" (1 Corinthians 15:3-4) — meaning the Old Testament Scriptures, the only ones the church had at first.

Four ways the Old Testament points forward

To read well, it helps to know the four threads we will be following:

Direct prophecy. Statements that predict — a ruler from Judah (Genesis 49:10), a child born in Bethlehem (Micah 5:2), a suffering servant (Isaiah 53), one pierced whom they would mourn (Zechariah 12:10).

Types and patterns. People and events shaped like Christ before He came: a beloved son offered up, a rejected brother who saves, a lamb whose blood turns away death, a bronze serpent lifted up. The New Testament calls these "a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Christ's" (Colossians 2:17).

The covenants. God's promises to Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, and David — each one advancing a single plan that comes to a head in Jesus.

The longings. The unfinished ache of the whole Old Testament: a better priest, a better king, a better sacrifice, a returned presence of God, a circumcised heart. The Old Testament keeps raising hopes it cannot itself satisfy.

A word of caution

Reading Christ in the Old Testament can be done badly — by force, by allegorical fancy, by ignoring what a text meant to its first hearers. We will try to be careful. A real type resembles Christ in a way the New Testament itself confirms or that the pattern plainly bears. We are not playing word games; we are tracing a design.

So let us begin where the Bible begins, with a promise made in the ruins of the first disaster.

Chapter Two — The Seed of the Woman

A promise spoken to a serpent

Humanity's first day outside the garden is also the day of the first promise. God speaks judgment over the serpent, and inside that judgment He hides a gospel:

"I will put hostility between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel." — Genesis 3:15 (WEB)

Read it slowly. There will be a "seed" — an offspring — of the woman, who will crush the serpent's head, though He will be wounded ("bruise his heel") in doing it. Christians have called this verse the *protoevangelium*, "the first gospel," because the whole story of redemption is folded inside it: an offspring of the woman, a mortal wound to the enemy, and a cost to the deliverer. Long before a single law was given, the hope of a coming deliverer was planted.

The narrowing of the seed

From that point, the Old Testament does something fascinating: it keeps narrowing the line of the promised "seed." Through Seth, through Noah, and then to a wandering man named Abraham, to whom God promises: "in you all the families of the earth will be blessed" (Genesis 12:3). The blessing for *all nations* will come through Abraham's offspring.

Here the apostle Paul makes an observation about the Hebrew text that has provoked debate ever since — and that sits right at the heart of your own study. God's promises were spoken "to Abraham and to his seed." Paul writes:

"He doesn't say, 'To descendants,' as of many, but as of one, 'and to your offspring,' which is Christ." — Galatians 3:16 (WEB)

Paul notices that the promise word is **singular** — "seed," not "seeds." His point is not a grammar trick; the Hebrew word *zera* (seed) can be collective. His point is theological: the entire promise to Abraham funnels down, finally, to **one** descendant in whom the blessing of all nations actually arrives — the Messiah. The many are blessed only because of the One.

The son who carried the wood

Then comes one of the most haunting scenes in all of Scripture. God tests Abraham, telling him to offer his beloved son Isaac on a mountain in the land of Moriah. Watch the details, because the New Testament will later light them up:

- The father takes his only beloved son to a mountain (Genesis 22:2).
- Isaac himself **carries the wood** for the offering up the hill (Genesis 22:6) — as Jesus would carry His own cross.
- Isaac asks, "where is the lamb?" and Abraham answers by faith, "God will provide himself the lamb" (Genesis 22:7-8).
- At the last second a substitute is provided — a ram caught in a thicket — and Isaac lives.

Abraham names the place "Yahweh Will Provide," and the narrator adds, "as it is said to this day, 'On Yahweh's mountain, it will be provided'" (Genesis 22:14). Centuries later, on a hill in that same region, another beloved Son would carry the wood up the mountain — and this time there would be no ram in the thicket, because *He* was the Lamb God provided. The pattern set on Moriah was waiting for its fulfillment.

The scepter that would not depart

As the patriarch Jacob blesses his sons, he speaks a strange prophecy over Judah:

"The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he comes to whom it belongs. To him will the obedience of the peoples be." — Genesis 49:10 (WEB)

A ruler is coming from the tribe of Judah to whom the obedience of *the peoples* — the nations — belongs. The seed of the woman, the offspring of Abraham, will be a king from Judah. The portrait is gaining features. Now it needs a face, and the next layer of the Old Testament gives us one — in the most unexpected of brothers.

Chapter Three — Joseph, the Rejected Brother Who Saves

A story too shaped to be an accident

The longest single story in Genesis is the story of Joseph — and it is told with such deliberate shape that the New Testament writers, and Jesus Himself, treat the pattern of the rejected-brother-who-saves as one of the deep grooves of Scripture. Lay Joseph's life beside the life of Jesus and the resemblance is hard to unsee.

- Joseph is the **beloved son** of his father, sent to his brothers (Genesis 37:3, 13). Jesus is the beloved Son sent to His own (John 1:11).
- His brothers **hate him** and reject his dreams of authority (Genesis 37:8). Jesus' own people reject His kingship.
- He is **sold for silver** — twenty pieces — by his brother Judah's idea (Genesis 37:26-28). Jesus is sold for thirty pieces of silver by Judas (a Greek form of Judah).
- He is **condemned with two prisoners**, one who lives and one who dies (Genesis 40). Jesus is crucified between two criminals, one who turns to Him and one who does not.
- He is exalted from the prison to the **right hand of the throne**, given a new name, and all must bow the knee to him (Genesis 41:40-43). Jesus is raised from death to the right hand of God, given the name above every name, before whom every knee will bow.
- And finally, the saving turn: the brothers who betrayed him come to him in their hunger, and he **forgives** them and feeds them and weeps over them.

"You meant evil... God meant it for good"

The theological heart of the Joseph story is a single sentence he speaks to the brothers who sold him into slavery:

"As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good, to save many people alive, as is happening today." — Genesis 50:20 (WEB)

This is the logic of the cross written centuries early. Wicked human hands do their worst; God, without excusing the evil, weaves it into the rescue of many. Peter would preach exactly this about Jesus at Pentecost: "him, being delivered up by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God, you have... crucified and killed" (Acts 2:23). The betrayal was real and guilty. The salvation was real and sovereign. Joseph is the pattern; Christ is the substance.

Why the pattern matters

Notice what is happening across these chapters. Long before there is a doctrine of atonement, the Bible is teaching its readers a *shape* — the shape of a beloved son, rejected by his own, descending into a pit and a prison, raised to a throne, and using his exaltation to forgive and feed the very people who betrayed him. By the time Jesus arrives, the shape is familiar to anyone soaked in Scripture. He does not break the pattern. He fulfills it.

The Old Testament keeps doing this — teaching us the melody so that we will recognize the song when the singer finally comes. The next layer teaches it through blood.

Chapter Four — The Lamb and the Exodus

A nation born through blood

The defining event of the Old Testament — the one Israel would remember every year forever — is the Exodus from Egypt. And at its center is a lamb.

On the night of the final plague, every household in Egypt is under the same sentence of death. Israel is not spared because they are better; they are spared because of blood. Each family is to take a lamb "without defect" (Exodus 12:5), kill it, and put its blood on the doorposts. God's word is precise:

"The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you." — Exodus 12:13 (WEB)

Notice what saves them. Not their worthiness, not their effort — the blood of a substitute, applied to the door. Death still comes that night; it simply falls on the lamb instead of the firstborn. Israel walks out of slavery the next morning as a people redeemed by blood.

"Behold, the Lamb of God"

For fifteen hundred years, Israel kept the Passover, eating the lamb, telling the story, waiting. Then a prophet named John saw Jesus walking toward him and said seven words that detonate the whole pattern:

"Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" — John 1:29 (WEB)

The Lamb. Not *a* lamb — *the* Lamb, the one all the others had been pointing to. Paul says it without flinching: "For indeed Christ, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place" (1 Corinthians 5:7). And John's Gospel notes that Jesus died at Passover, and that, like the Passover lamb, "a bone of him will not be broken" (John 19:36, citing Exodus 12:46). The timing was not a coincidence. It was an appointment kept.

The serpent lifted up

The Exodus generation gives us one more startling picture. When venomous serpents bite the grumbling people in the wilderness, God's remedy is strange: Moses makes a bronze serpent, lifts it on a pole, and "if a serpent had bitten any man, when he looked to the serpent of

bronze, he lived" (Numbers 21:9). They are not healed by working harder; they are healed by *looking* in faith at the lifted-up cure.

Jesus reached back and grabbed this exact image to explain His own death:

"As Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life." — John 3:14-15 (WEB)

The serpent — the symbol of the curse from Genesis 3 — is lifted up, and the dying live by looking. On the cross, the One who "knew no sin" was "made to be sin on our behalf" (2 Corinthians 5:21), lifted up so that all who look to Him in faith will live. The wilderness was rehearsing Calvary.

The portrait now has blood in it, and a way of salvation: a substitute, a lifted-up cure, a people redeemed not by effort but by faith. Next the Old Testament builds Him a house — and shows us it was only ever a model.

Chapter Five — Moses, the Tabernacle, and the Pattern of Heaven

A tent built from a blueprint

After the Exodus, God gives Moses elaborate instructions for a tent of worship — the tabernacle — and later the temple. Why does the Bible spend so many chapters on curtains, furniture, and priestly robes? The New Testament gives the reason, and it changes everything:

"They serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly things, even as Moses was warned by God... 'See, you shall make everything according to the pattern that was shown to you on the mountain.'" — Hebrews 8:5 (WEB)

The tabernacle was never the real thing. It was a scale model of a heavenly reality, built "according to the pattern." Every piece was a teaching aid: the altar where blood was shed, the laver for washing, the bread of the presence, the lampstand, the veil, and behind the veil the ark where God's presence dwelt. The whole structure said one thing over and over: a holy God will dwell with sinful people, but only through sacrifice, cleansing, and a mediator.

The veil and the access

At the center of the tabernacle hung a thick veil, separating the people from the Most Holy Place where God's presence rested. Only the high priest could pass through it, once a year, with blood. The message was unmistakable: the way to God is not yet open.

Then, at the moment Jesus died, Matthew records that "the veil of the temple was torn in two from the top to the bottom" (Matthew 27:51). From the top — as if torn by a hand from above, not below. The book of Hebrews explains the meaning: through His flesh, Jesus has opened "a new and living way" through the veil, so that we may now "draw near with a true heart in fullness of faith" (Hebrews 10:20-22). The model had a locked door for fifteen centuries. The reality flung it open.

Moses and the better Mediator

Moses himself becomes a pattern of Christ. He is the mediator who stands between God and the people, the prophet who speaks God's words, the deliverer who leads them out of bondage. And remarkably, Moses prophesies that he is *not* the final word:

"Yahweh your God will raise up to you a prophet from among you, of your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him." — Deuteronomy 18:15 (WEB)

A prophet "like Moses" was coming, and Israel was to listen to *Him*. The New Testament identifies that prophet as Jesus (Acts 3:22). But the comparison cuts both ways, for Hebrews insists Jesus is *greater* than Moses — Moses was "faithful in all God's house as a servant," but Christ is faithful "as a Son over his house" (Hebrews 3:5-6). Moses could lead Israel out of Egypt; he could not lead them into the Promised Land — that fell to Joshua (in Hebrew, *Yeshua*, the same name as "Jesus"). The law given through Moses could expose the problem; only Jesus could bring the people home.

The portrait now has a temple, a torn veil, and a mediator greater than Moses. Next the Old Testament gives Him a crown.

Chapter Six — The King: David, Goliath, and the Son of David

A shepherd-king from Bethlehem

God chooses an unlikely shepherd boy from Bethlehem named David and makes him king, then makes him a promise that towers over the rest of the Old Testament:

"Your house and your kingdom will be made sure forever before you. Your throne will be established forever." — 2 Samuel 7:16 (WEB)

A son of David would have an *everlasting* throne. But David died, and so did every son who sat on his throne, and eventually the throne itself was lost in exile. The promise hung unfulfilled over Israel for a thousand years, a debt God had pledged to pay. The prophets kept the hope alive — a child would be born, "and the government will be on his shoulders... Of the increase of his government and of peace there shall be no end, on David's throne" (Isaiah 9:6-7).

When the angel comes to Mary, he reaches straight back to that thousand-year-old promise: "the Lord God will give to him the throne of his father David... and of his Kingdom there will be no end" (Luke 1:32-33). The crowds who shouted "Hosanna to the son of David!" knew exactly what they were claiming. The Bethlehem shepherd's greater Son had come.

David, Goliath, and Golgotha

One of your own Scroll threads sits here — the strange resonance between David's most famous battle and the place of the cross. The pattern is worth seeing.

David faces Goliath not as one soldier among many but as Israel's *representative*: the whole nation's fate rests on one man's victory, and when he wins, the people share in a triumph they did not fight for (1 Samuel 17). He strikes the giant in the head — an echo of Genesis 3:15, the seed crushing the serpent's head — using the enemy's own weapon, and he does it in "the valley of Elah" before a watching army.

There is even a curious geographical thread: David takes the head of the Philistine champion to Jerusalem (1 Samuel 17:54), and the place of the skull — *Golgotha* — is where the true Son of David would one day win the decisive single-combat victory over the true enemy, again as the people's representative, again by what looked like weakness, again striking the serpent's head while taking a wound Himself. We hold such patterns humbly — Scripture

does not spell out every link — but the shape is unmistakable: one representative champion, a victory the people share without earning, a blow to the head of the enemy in the place of the skull.

The King who is also the Lord

David himself wrote something that Jesus used to stump the experts. In Psalm 110, David writes, "Yahweh says to my Lord, 'Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies your footstool'" (Psalm 110:1). Jesus asked the teachers: if the Messiah is merely David's son, why does David call Him "my Lord"? (Matthew 22:41-46). The answer the Old Testament was driving toward is that the Son of David is also David's Lord — the human king who is somehow also divine. The crown the Old Testament forges for the Messiah is too heavy for a merely human head.

The portrait now wears David's crown. But there is one more layer — the deepest and most painful — where the Old Testament shows the King must first be a Lamb, a Priest, and a pierced Shepherd. To that we now turn.

Chapter Seven — The Priest, the Scapegoat, and the Pierced One

A priest from before the law

Long before Israel had priests, a mysterious figure meets Abraham: Melchizedek, "king of Salem" and "priest of God Most High," who brings out bread and wine and blesses him (Genesis 14:18-20). He appears from nowhere, with no recorded genealogy, and vanishes. Centuries later David writes that the Messiah will be "a priest forever, after the order of Melchizedek" (Psalm 110:4).

Why does this matter? Because Israel's regular priests came from the tribe of Levi, served until they died, and offered sacrifices that had to be repeated endlessly. The book of Hebrews seizes on Melchizedek to show that the Messiah is a *different kind* of priest — one who does not inherit the office from a dying father but holds it "by the power of an endless life" (Hebrews 7:16), one whose single sacrifice never needs repeating. Jesus is both the King from Judah *and* the Priest like Melchizedek — a combination no ordinary Israelite could ever hold. The bread and wine Melchizedek brought out hint at the table Jesus would one day spread.

The two goats and the Day of Atonement

On Israel's holiest day, the Day of Atonement, two goats were brought before the priest (Leviticus 16). One was sacrificed, its blood carried behind the veil to cover sin. The other — the "scapegoat" — had the people's sins confessed over its head and was then driven away into the wilderness, "and the goat shall carry on itself all their iniquities to a solitary land" (Leviticus 16:22).

Two goats, one redemption: one died to pay; one carried sin *away*. Together they say what one animal could not — that atonement both pays the penalty and removes the guilt as far as the east is from the west. Both meet in Jesus, who "was once offered to bear the sins of many" (Hebrews 9:28) and of whom John the Baptist said He "takes away the sin of the world." Your Scroll even traced the thread to Jesus' baptism, where the sinless One steps into the place of sinners — the One who would carry sin away begins by standing where the guilty stand.

"They will look to me whom they have pierced"

Now the prophets bring the portrait to its most astonishing focus. Isaiah, seven centuries before the cross, describes a servant who suffers not for His own sin but for ours:

"He was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed."
— Isaiah 53:5 (WEB)

Read the whole chapter and it is difficult to believe it was written *before* the event it describes: despised and rejected, silent before His accusers, "led like a lamb to the slaughter," numbered with transgressors, buried with the rich, and yet afterward seeing "the result of the suffering of his soul" (Isaiah 53:11). This is the Lamb, the substitute, the sin-bearer — sketched in advance.

And the prophet Zechariah, another of your study threads, adds a line that names the unthinkable. Speaking as God Himself, Yahweh says:

"They will look to me whom they have pierced; and they shall mourn for him, as one mourns for his only son." — Zechariah 12:10 (WEB)

Notice the pronouns: *they pierced me*, and they will mourn for *him* — God speaks of being pierced, and of the pierced one as a distinct "him," an only son. John quotes this verse at the foot of the cross, when the soldier's spear opens Jesus' side: "They will look on him whom they pierced" (John 19:37). The God of Israel said His people would one day look on the One they pierced. At Golgotha, they did.

The Son of Man on the clouds

Finally, the prophet Daniel sees the end of the story. In a night vision he watches "one like a son of man" come "with the clouds of the sky" to the Ancient of Days, and to this human-yet-heavenly figure is given "dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all the peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion" (Daniel 7:13-14). The worship and everlasting kingdom that belong to God alone are given to "one like a son of man."

This was Jesus' favorite title for Himself — "the Son of Man" — and at His trial He claimed Daniel's vision outright: "you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power, and coming with the clouds of the sky" (Mark 14:62), for which He was condemned. The rejected Lamb and the enthroned Son of Man are the same person. The story that began with a promise to a serpent ends with a kingdom that never ends.

The portrait, unveiled

Step back and look at the finished portrait. The seed of the woman who crushes the serpent. The offspring of Abraham who blesses the nations. The beloved son carrying the wood up the mountain. The rejected brother who is sold for silver and saves those who betrayed him. The Passover Lamb whose blood turns away death. The serpent lifted up so the dying can look and live. The tabernacle's torn veil. The prophet greater than Moses. The Son of David with an everlasting throne. The Priest after the order of Melchizedek. The scapegoat who carries sin away. The Servant pierced for our transgressions. The pierced One whom Yahweh calls "me." The Son of Man on the clouds.

Every line was drawn before He came. That is why the two on the Emmaus road felt their hearts burning — not because the stranger invented a meaning, but because He finally read aloud the meaning that had been there all along.

So the question this book leaves you with is the question those travelers had to answer when their eyes were opened:

If the whole of the Old Testament was a portrait of this one Person — what will you do, now that you have seen His face?

Conclusion — Come and See

The Old Testament is not a closed museum. It is a portrait gallery, and every hall leads to the same face. Jesus did not abolish the Hebrew Scriptures; He fulfilled them — "I didn't come to destroy, but to fulfill" (Matthew 5:17). He is the seed, the lamb, the temple, the prophet, the king, the priest, and the pierced Shepherd, gathered into one life, one death, and one resurrection.

If you are a believer, read your Old Testament again with these eyes, and let your heart burn. If you are still weighing it, do what the first disciples did — bring your doubt and "come and see" (John 1:46). And if you are ready, the whole portrait has only ever been inviting you to one thing:

*"Come to me, all you who labor and are heavily burdened, and I will give you rest."
— Matthew 11:28 (WEB)*

The One the Scriptures were pointing to is the One who is, even now, pointing back to you.

About this book

Christ Hidden in Plain Sight is published freely by **Hope of Glory Ministry** so that the earth may be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the Lord. It may be read, shared, and given away without charge. All Scripture is from the World English Bible (public domain). We hold the historic Nicene faith and the plain reading of Scripture; we compare beliefs and never demean persons.

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"For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the glory of Yahweh, as the waters cover the sea." — Habakkuk 2:14 (WEB)